



HISTORY HACK · U.S. HISTORY

Flight Log

Student Follow-Along Workbook

*A companion to *To Form a More Perfect Union**

Tennessee U.S. History · 1877–Present

How to fly this workbook

- **Notice first.** At every stop, Spark shows you something real. Write what you actually see — not what you think you're supposed to say.
- **Debrief honestly.** Notetaker's questions rarely have one answer. Give your read and the evidence behind it.
- **The Arc is yours.** You decide whether each milestone moved the country toward its promise or away. Historians disagree too — so defend your call.
- **Use your book.** Every activity points back to a unit you can reread. This log is where *your* thinking lives.

The Nation Turns West — and the Cities Rise

The Rise of Industrialization · 1877–1900 | Standards US.01, US.02, US.03, US.04, US.05, US.06, US.07

Name _____

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

As America industrialized, the same forces — the railroad, the factory, the open door — meant opportunity for some and loss for others. Whose America was being built, and at whose expense?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

homestead	_____	assimilation	_____
	_____		_____
Jim Crow	_____	political machine	_____
	_____		_____
Gospel of Wealth	_____	nativism	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze how the Homestead Act and the transcontinental railroad drove westward settlement, and why the same expansion was opportunity for settlers... Notice: Here's the deal: move onto 160 acres, live there five years, plant something — and the land is yours. Free. Forever. No catch. Except the "empty"... Debrief: Anna and Chaska describe the same acres in opposite terms. Using one detail from each column, explain how the Homestead Act could be a genuine promise and a genuine injustice at the same time.	
2	Analyze how the reservation system, the Dawes Act, and boarding schools sought to dissolve Native landholding and identity through forced... Notice: New rules at your new school: they hold you down and cut your hair, hand you a brand-new name, and punish you every single time you speak the... Debrief: Reformers called the boarding schools and the Dawes Act a benefit to Native people. Give the intended goal and the actual effect of this assimilation policy.	
3	Explain how the Compromise of 1877 ended Reconstruction and enabled Jim Crow, and evaluate the Freedmen's Bureau's intended role through a period... Notice: Picture the refs strolling off the field at halftime — and the other team gets to write the rules for the next eighty years. That's about what... Debrief: The Compromise of 1877 is often described as the 'end of Reconstruction.' Explain what changed for Black Southerners like Isaiah when federal troops withdrew, using the cartoon and Isaiah's column as evidence.	
4	Analyze Gilded Age politics and economics — the power of trusts and machines and the divide between capitalists and wage earners — using a period... Notice: There's always a group that you're not in — the one where the real decisions actually get made. In 1889 a cartoonist drew America's version of it... Debrief: In 'The Bosses of the Senate,' the trusts are drawn as giants and the senators as tiny figures, with the 'People's Entrance' bolted shut. What is the cartoonist arguing about Gilded Age government, and which groups are left powerless?	
5	Describe how industrial leaders and innovations transformed American life, and weigh the Gospel of Wealth against the conditions of the workers... Notice: A billionaire posts about donating a hospital wing — while the people who actually built his fortune can't cover rent. Real generosity, or a... Debrief: Andrew Carnegie's 'Gospel of Wealth' and the 'Next!' cartoon describe the same industrialists very differently. Make a claim about how much the Gospel of Wealth justified Gilded Age inequality, cite both sources, and explain your reasoning.	
6	Analyze how industrialization and immigration drove the growth of major industrial cities and shaped urban labor and living conditions. Notice: Your town runs on people who can't afford to live in it — the drivers, the cooks, the crew cleaning the building at five in the morning. That's... Debrief: Using the Ellis Island photograph and the 1890 foreign-born map, explain the relationship between immigration and the growth of America's industrial cities.	
7	Compare 'old' and 'new' immigrants and analyze nativist responses, using a period photograph of tenement conditions. Notice: Same person steps off the boat. One country calls them an 'expat.' Another calls them an 'immigrant.' Another calls them a 'problem.' Same human... Debrief: Return to the essential question: whose America was being built, and at whose expense? Make a claim, cite evidence from at least two different spreads (including at least one image), and explain how opportunity and loss could be two sides of the same industrial expansion.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 1 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **Golden Spike Ceremony at Promontory Summit, Utah, May 10, 1869 — completion of the first transcontinental railroad.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *Everyone in this famous photo is celebrating. Ask: who is not in the picture? Whose land and labor made this moment possible but were left out of...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1869	Homestead Act & transcontinental railroad		
1877	Compromise of 1877 ends Reconstruction		
1881	Tennessee's separate-car law		
1887	Dawes Act		
1890	Sherman Antitrust Act		
1892	Ida B. Wells's anti-lynching campaign		
1896	Tennessee ends convict leasing		
1901	NY Tenement House Act		
1911	Standard Oil broken up		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This unit is one chapter of a project older than any of us - the one the Constitution names in its first line: forming 'a more perfect union.'...

Closing question: Look for a pattern across these seven stories: a problem gets ignored until it hurts people badly enough that someone refuses to stay silent - and their voice (a photograph, a newspaper, a strike, a vote) pushes the government to act. Sometimes the fix came fast (the Sherman Antitrust Act; Tennessee ending convict leasing). Sometimes it took generations (a federal anti-lynching law). Sometimes the government itself caused the harm (federal Indian policy). Choose two moments from this unit and argue, with evidence: in these years, did the country climb toward a 'more perfect union,' or slip back? There is no answer key - defend yours.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Turning the Light On

The Progressive Era • 1890–1920 | Standards US.08, US.09, US.10, US.11, US.12, US.13, US.14, US.15, US.16, US.17, US.18

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

When a booming country leaves millions behind, who decides to fix it — and how? Progressive-era Americans fought over whether the answer was charity, protest, journalism, unions, or the government itself. Which of them actually moved the country?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

Social Darwinism	_____	muckraker	_____
	_____		_____
trust	_____	collective bargaining	_____
	_____		_____
suffrage	_____	initiative & referendum	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze Social Darwinism as a justification for inequality, and compare Washington's and Du Bois's strategies for Black advancement. Notice: Somebody tells you the rich are rich because they're simply better — stronger, smarter, more deserving — and the poor earned their poverty by... Debrief: Washington and Du Bois wanted the same goal but chose opposite strategies. Explain each strategy in one sentence, then argue which one you think fit the dangers of 1900 better — using evidence.	
2	Explain how farmers (Granger/Populist) and workers (labor unions) organized to fight railroads and industry — and what it cost them. Notice: One company sets the price, and you have no choice but to pay it — sound familiar? For Anna's family, that company was the railroad, and the price... Debrief: Farmers and industrial workers used different tactics but shared one core idea. Name the shared idea, then give one tactic each group used and one risk each faced.	
3	Analyze how trusts concentrated power, and how Roosevelt's Square Deal and Wilson's New Freedom used government to check it. Notice: Imagine one company owns the app, the phone, the store, and the road to the store — so there's nowhere else to go and no price but theirs. That... Debrief: Trace one path from problem to fix: start with the power of the trusts, and explain how journalism and government together checked it. Name at least one muckraker and one law or agency.	
4	Analyze industrial working conditions — child labor, sweatshops, and the Triangle fire — and the reforms they provoked. Notice: 146 people went to work one morning and never came home — most of them girls not much older than you, some younger. The factory doors were locked... Debrief: The Triangle fire is often called a turning point. Explain what conditions caused so many deaths, and how the tragedy changed what the government required of factories.	
5	Explain how muckrakers exposed abuses and mobilized public support for reform. Notice: You post a video of something wrong — a scam, a cover-up — and by morning it's everywhere and somebody powerful has to answer for it. That... Debrief: Explain how a single book led to a federal law in 1906 — and why Sinclair considered the result a partial failure.	
6	Analyze Progressive democratic reforms that expanded citizen control (initiative, referendum, recall, direct primaries, 16th & 17th Amendments). Notice: What if you could skip the middleman and vote directly on the rule itself — no crooked politician required? That's not a fantasy app. It's what... Debrief: Choose two Progressive democratic reforms and explain how each one shifted power away from political machines or state legislatures and toward ordinary citizens.	
7	Analyze the women's suffrage movement and the ratification of the 19th Amendment — decided in Tennessee. Notice: It comes down to one vote. One state left to make women's suffrage the law of the land, and that state is Tennessee. The count is tied. And the... Debrief: The 19th Amendment is a triumph and an unfinished one. Explain how women won the vote (including Tennessee's deciding role) AND why the victory was incomplete for many Black women.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 2 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **dubois-souls**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *Both men were brilliant, brave, and right about some things. Instead of picking a 'winner,' ask: what did each strategy risk, and what did each...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1892	Homestead Strike crushed		
1895	Atlanta Compromise (Washington)		
1906	Pure Food & Drug and Meat Inspection Acts		
1911	Triangle Shirtwaist fire		
1913	17th Amendment (direct election of senators)		
1914	Clayton Act & Federal Trade Commission		
1920	19th Amendment ratified in Tennessee		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

If Unit 1 was the country growing fast and leaving people behind, Unit 2 is the country arguing about what it owes the people it left. Watch...

Closing question: Across this unit you saw at least five kinds of power try to fix a broken system: charity, protest, unions, journalism, and the law. Pick the two you think actually moved the country the most, cite evidence from the unit, and defend your ranking. There's no answer key — make the case.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

On the Menu

Imperialism & World War I · 1898–1919 | Standards US.19, US.20, US.21, US.22, US.23, US.24, US.25, US.26, US.27

Name _____

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

In one generation the United States went from healing its own wounds to reaching across the whole world — buying navies, taking islands, and finally sending two million young men to a war in the mud of France. When a country grows into a world power, who pays for the growth? And when it wins, what does it owe the people it now controls?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

imperialism	_____	anti-imperialist	_____
	_____		_____
yellow journalism	_____	Big Stick diplomacy	_____
	_____		_____
militarism	_____	propaganda	_____
	_____		_____
self-determination	_____	League of Nations	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the economic, strategic, and ideological motives behind American imperialism, and the debate between imperialists and anti-imperialists. Notice: Picture a menu — but the items aren't food. They're countries. Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, Hawaii, all laid out like dishes, and a giant... Debrief: Name the three main motives for American imperialism, then explain the core argument the Anti-Imperialist League used against it. Whose reasoning do you find stronger, and why?	
2	Analyze the causes, course, and consequences of the Spanish-American War, and how Roosevelt's Big Stick and Taft's Dollar Diplomacy extended U.S.... Notice: A ship blows up in a harbor. Nobody knows exactly why. But two newspapers, locked in a war for readers, splash it across their front pages... Debrief: Explain how the Spanish-American War turned the U.S. into an imperial power, then compare Big Stick and Dollar Diplomacy as two ways of using that new power. Include the war's consequences for Filipinos.	
3	Analyze the long-term causes of World War I (MAIN) and the reasons the United States abandoned neutrality and entered the war. Notice: Europe in 1914 was a room full of people soaked in gasoline, and everyone was holding a match and swearing they'd only light it if someone else... Debrief: Explain the MAIN causes of World War I, then explain how the U.S. moved from neutrality to war. Identify the two events that most turned American opinion.	
4	Analyze the American military experience in World War I — trench warfare, deadly new technologies, and Pershing's American Expeditionary Forces —... Notice: Imagine a war where you live in a muddy ditch for months, where poison gas can roll in on the wind, where a machine gun can cut down a hundred men... Debrief: Describe what made World War I combat so deadly, and explain the role of the American Expeditionary Forces. Then explain why Alvin York's story is more complicated than 'brave soldier.'	
5	Analyze the World War I home front — women's expanded roles, mobilization and war bonds, and the Committee on Public Information's propaganda. Notice: Here's something they don't always tell you about war: most of the people fighting it never see the front. They're at home, and their whole world... Debrief: Describe two major ways World War I changed the American home front, then explain what the Committee on Public Information was and one reason it is controversial.	
6	Analyze Wilson's Fourteen Points, the Treaty of Versailles, and the debate over the League of Nations — including Tennessee's internationalist voice. Notice: The war is over. Ten million soldiers are dead. And an American president stands up and says: what if we made sure this never happens again? What... Debrief: Explain Wilson's Fourteen Points and the League of Nations, then explain why the U.S. Senate rejected the Treaty of Versailles. Was the Senate's decision wise or a mistake? Defend your answer.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 3 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **This 1898 political cartoon depicts Uncle Sam as a customer eyeing a menu of Spanish colonies like Cuba and the Philippines served by President McKinley, critiquing U.S. imperial ambitions during the Spanish-American War as covered in Tennessee US.26.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?

2. Spark's question: *This is the 'menu' cartoon itself — Uncle Sam deciding which country to 'order,' served by President McKinley. Ask: the cartoonist drew whole...*

3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1898	Spanish-American War: the U.S. becomes an empire		
1899	Philippine-American War		
1904	Panama Canal & the Roosevelt Corollary (Big Stick)		
1917	The United States enters World War I		
1918	The Fourteen Points: a new vision of peace		
1919	The Senate rejects the Treaty and the League		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

Units 1 and 2 asked what the country owed the people inside it. Unit 3 asks a bigger, harder version: what does a rising world power owe the...

Closing question: This unit put a hard idea on the table: a nation can grow more powerful at the same moment it does real harm to a people. Choose one event from this unit and argue two things at once — how it strengthened the United States, AND what it cost, and to whom. Then take a stand: was the trade worth it? Cite the unit. There's no answer key — make the case honestly.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Who Got to Roar

The Roaring Twenties · 1920–1929 | Standards US.28, US.29, US.30, US.31, US.32, US.33, US.34, US.35, US.36, US.37, US.38

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

The 1920s are remembered as one long party — jazz, cars, radio, and easy money. But a decade can roar for some people while it slams the door on others. Who actually got to roar in the Twenties, who got shut out, and was a country changing this fast becoming freer — or just louder?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

Great Migration	_____	Harlem Renaissance	_____
	_____		_____
mass culture	_____	flapper	_____
	_____		_____
fundamentalism vs. modernism	_____	Prohibition	_____
	_____		_____
buying on margin	_____	nativism	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the causes and effects of the Great Migration, and how it fed the Harlem Renaissance's celebration of Black identity. Notice: Imagine leaving the only home you've ever known — not for a vacation, but because staying could get you killed. You pack one suitcase, board a... Debrief: Explain the Great Migration using push and pull factors, then explain how it connected to the Harlem Renaissance. Use one piece of evidence (a source or figure) from the spread.	
2	Explain how radio spread American music nationwide, making Nashville the capital of country music and carrying the blues into the mainstream. Notice: Your favorite song right now — how did you find it? A stream, an algorithm, a phone. Now erase all of that. In 1925 a brand-new machine did... Debrief: Explain how radio changed American music in the 1920s, and give one example each of how it spread country music and the blues. Why is Tennessee central to this story?	
3	Analyze how radio and film, new technologies (aviation, electricity), and Ford's assembly line created a modern mass-consumer society. Notice: One man flies alone across an entire ocean, and by the time he lands, the whole planet already knows his name — because a new machine carried the... Debrief: Choose two of these — radio/film, aviation or electrification, or the automobile — and explain how each made American life more modern in the 1920s. Include one cost or trade-off.	
4	Analyze the changing roles and status of women in the 1920s — flappers, the birth-control movement, and the limits that remained. Notice: Cut your hair short. Wear what you want. Go out without asking permission. Get a job, spend your own money, and dance to music your grandmother... Debrief: Describe two ways women's lives changed in the 1920s and two limits that remained. Was the 'new woman' mostly real freedom or mostly hype? Defend your answer with evidence.	
5	Analyze the civil-liberties and civil-rights challenges of the 1920s — the Red Scare, the Klan's resurgence, the Tulsa massacre, and immigration... Notice: A country gets scared. Scared of radicals, scared of immigrants, scared of anyone who looks or prays or votes differently. And instead of talking... Debrief: Identify three examples of intolerance or civil-liberties violations in the 1920s, then explain how Americans organized to resist. Why might these events have been left out of the 'Roaring Twenties' story for so long?	
6	Analyze Prohibition — its goals, its unintended consequences (organized crime), and its ultimate failure and repeal. Notice: What happens when you make something illegal that millions of people refuse to stop wanting? You don't end it — you just hand the whole business... Debrief: Explain why many Americans supported Prohibition, then explain its main unintended consequences and why it was repealed. What general lesson does Prohibition teach about laws?	
7	Analyze the Scopes Trial as a dramatization of the clash between fundamentalism and modernism — staged in Dayton, Tennessee. Notice: A small Tennessee town. A young teacher. A law that makes it a crime to teach where humans came from. In the summer of 1925, the whole country —... Debrief: Explain what the Scopes Trial was about and why it mattered beyond one teacher. Represent both Bryan's and Darrow's positions fairly, then explain why historians say 'no one really won.'	
8	Analyze the economic weaknesses of the 1920s — easy credit, stock speculation, and inequality — that set up the Great Depression. Notice: Buy it now, pay later. Put ten percent down and borrow the rest. Everyone's getting rich in the stock market, so throw your money in — prices only... Debrief: Explain three economic weaknesses of the 1920s (credit, speculation, inequality) and how each helped set up the Great Depression. Which do you think	

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
	was most dangerous, and why?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 4 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **An African American family of nine, dressed in coats and hats with their suitcases at their feet, photographed shortly after arriving in Chicago during the Great Migration, when hundreds of thousands of Black Americans moved from the rural South to northern cities.**²⁸ on the Great Migration.

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is a real family, photographed just after arriving in Chicago from the South around 1920 — coats on, suitcases at their feet. Ask: what can...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1920	Prohibition begins (18th Amendment)		
1921	Tulsa Race Massacre		
1924	National Origins Act restricts immigration		
1925	The Great Migration and Harlem Renaissance		
1925	The Grand Ole Opry puts Nashville on the map		
1925	The Scopes Trial		
1929	The credit boom crests		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The Twenties are the trickiest decade yet for the 'more perfect union' question, because progress and backlash happen at the exact same time. The...

Closing question: The 1920s advanced some Americans and set others back — often in the very same year. Pick two events from this unit that pulled the country in opposite directions, and use them to argue whether the decade, on balance, moved the United States closer to its founding promise or further from it. Cite the unit. There's no answer key — make the case.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

When the Bottom Fell Out

The Great Depression & the New Deal · 1929–1941 | Standards US.39, US.40, US.41, US.42, US.43, US.44

Name _____

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

In 1929 the richest country on earth fell into its worst economic disaster, and one in four workers lost their jobs through no fault of their own. When the bottom falls out for millions of people, whose job is it to catch them — themselves, their neighbors, or their government? The answer America argued out in the 1930s still shapes your life today.

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

buying on margin	_____	Dust Bowl	_____
	_____		_____
Hooverville	_____	rugged individualism	_____
	_____		_____
the New Deal	_____	Relief, Recovery, Reform	_____
	_____		_____
TVA	_____	court-packing	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the interlocking causes of the Great Depression — margin buying, bank failures, overproduction, and the Smoot-Hawley Tariff. Notice: You buy something with money you don't have, betting you'll pay it back when your investment goes up. Everybody's doing it, so it feels safe.... Debrief: Explain how a stock market crash turned into a decade-long Depression. Identify at least three causes and show how one caused or worsened another.	
2	Analyze the human-caused ecological disaster of the Dust Bowl and the forced migration and discrimination it produced. Notice: Imagine the sky itself turning against you. A wall of black dust two thousand feet high, rolling across the horizon at sixty miles an hour... Debrief: Explain why the Dust Bowl is called a 'human-caused' disaster, not just a natural one. Then describe what happened to families like Opal's, and how <i>The Grapes of Wrath</i> changed public understanding.	
3	Analyze the human toll of the Great Depression — mass unemployment, Hoovervilles, hunger, and the unequal way it fell. Notice: One in four. Picture your class, and cross out every fourth person's job — gone. Now imagine there's no unemployment check, no food stamps, no... Debrief: Describe three ways the Depression harmed ordinary Americans, and explain why it fell harder on some groups than others. Why might a photograph like 'Migrant Mother' change minds when statistics don't?	
4	Analyze Hoover's response to the Depression — 'rugged individualism,' the RFC, and the Bonus Army — and why it failed politically. Notice: You're the president. A quarter of the country is out of work, people are starving, and everyone is looking at you. You genuinely believe that if... Debrief: Explain Hoover's philosophy of 'rugged individualism' and how it shaped his response to the Depression. Then explain how the Bonus Army episode helped end his presidency. Was his philosophy wrong, or just wrong for this crisis? Defend your view.	
5	Analyze FDR's New Deal through the 'Three Rs' — Relief, Recovery, and Reform — and the lasting institutions it created. Notice: A minimum wage. A limit on your work week. Insurance so your grandparents don't starve when they're old. Insurance so your family's bank savings... Debrief: Explain the 'Three Rs' of the New Deal with one program for each. Then explain one way the New Deal fell short of helping all Americans equally. Which New Deal program do you think mattered most, and why?	
6	Analyze the Tennessee Valley Authority as the New Deal's most dramatic regional transformation — flood control, electrification, and its impact on... Notice: Flip a switch. Light. You've done it ten thousand times without a thought. Now imagine you're seventeen and you have never once done it — every... Debrief: Explain what the TVA did and why it mattered so much to the rural South. Then explain one benefit and one cost or controversy of a government building and owning something like the TVA.	
7	Analyze the opposition to the New Deal, the Supreme Court's rejection of key programs, and FDR's failed court-packing plan. Notice: What happens when a president does so much, so fast, that people start asking whether he's rescuing democracy or endangering it? The New Deal... Debrief: Explain why the New Deal faced opposition, how the Supreme Court responded, and why FDR's court-packing plan failed. What does this fight show about the balance of power in American government?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 5 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **hoover-business-sound-1929**

- 1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
- 2. Spark's question: *Four days later the market suffered the worst crash in its history, and within four years more than 9,000 banks had failed. Ask: why would the...*
- 3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1929	The stock market crash		
1932	The Bonus Army is driven from Washington		
1933	The New Deal begins		
1933	The TVA lights up the Tennessee Valley		
1935	Social Security is enacted		
1937	The court-packing plan fails		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This unit is where America rewrites the deal between a person and their government. For 150 years the answer to 'who catches you when you fall'...

Closing question: The New Deal permanently expanded what the federal government does for ordinary people — and Americans have argued about whether that was rescue or overreach ever since. Using at least two programs from this unit, argue whether the New Deal moved the country closer to its founding promise or further from it. Then name one thing it left unfinished. Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

The Whole World at War

World War II • 1939–1945 | Standards US.45, US.46, US.47, US.48, US.49, US.50, US.51, US.52, US.53, US.54, US.55, US.56, US.57, US.58

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

World War II asked the United States to save democracy abroad — while it was still denying democracy to millions of its own people at home. Can a country fight for freedom in the world and against it at home, at the same time? And when winning the war meant building the most terrible weapon ever made — in Tennessee — what did victory finally cost?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

fascism		isolationism	
the Holocaust		Double V	
internment		Rosie the Riveter	
Manhattan Project		United Nations	

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the rise of fascism and totalitarianism in Europe, and how FDR moved a reluctant America from isolationism toward supporting the democracies. Notice: Picture a hundred thousand people packed into a stadium at night, torches blazing, every arm raised in perfect unison to one man on a distant... Debrief: Define fascism and give two examples of fascist or totalitarian regimes. Then explain why most Americans were isolationist, and how FDR moved the country toward helping the Allies before Pearl Harbor.	
2	Analyze the attack on Pearl Harbor and U.S. entry into the war, and identify the key Allied leaders and their roles. Notice: It's a sleepy Sunday morning. Sailors are still in their bunks, some at breakfast, the band tuning up for the flag-raising. And then the sky fills... Debrief: Explain what happened at Pearl Harbor and why it ended American isolationism. Then identify two Allied leaders and each one's role in the war.	
3	Analyze the major American military campaigns in the European and Pacific theaters — D-Day, Midway, and the island-hopping fight to Iwo Jima. Notice: You're nineteen, in a flat-bottomed boat crossing a freezing sea toward a beach you've never seen. The ramp drops. Ahead is open sand, then... Debrief: Describe the significance of D-Day and one Pacific campaign. Explain how the two-theater war led toward Allied victory, and give one detail that conveys its human cost.	
4	Analyze the Holocaust and the evolving U.S. response — from refusing Jewish refugees before the war to liberating the camps at its end. Notice: Before the shooting ever reached America, a ship full of desperate people sailed to within sight of the Florida coast — and was turned away. Nine... Debrief: Explain what the Holocaust was, and describe how the U.S. response evolved from before the war to its end. Why did Eisenhower order the camps documented?	
5	Analyze how Americans who faced discrimination at home — the Tuskegee Airmen and Black defense workers — fought for a 'Double V': victory abroad... Notice: Imagine risking your life for a country that makes you use a separate water fountain. You put on the uniform, you fly the missions, you bleed for... Debrief: Explain the 'Double V' campaign. Use the Tuskegee Airmen and Executive Order 8802 as examples of Black Americans fighting on two fronts. How did this experience connect to the later civil-rights movement?	
6	Analyze how the war transformed women's roles (Rosie the Riveter) and required total civilian mobilization (rationing, bonds, POW camps) on the... Notice: They told women their place was the kitchen — right up until the country needed them to build the bombers. Almost overnight, millions of women... Debrief: Explain two major ways the war changed the American home front, including women's roles. Why might the government have promoted images like 'Rosie the Riveter,' and what happened to many women workers after the war?	
7	Analyze the internment of Japanese Americans under Executive Order 9066 as a grave civil-liberties violation driven by prejudice, not security. Notice: You are an American citizen. You were born here, you pledge allegiance here, this is the only country you've ever known. Then one day the... Debrief: Explain what Executive Order 9066 did and why historians say it was based on prejudice, not security. Then explain how the story of the 442nd Regiment makes the injustice even clearer. Why does the government's later apology matter?	

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
8	Analyze the Manhattan Project — including Oak Ridge, Tennessee — and the decision to drop the atomic bombs, weighing its justifications and its... Notice: A secret city rises in the Tennessee hills, so hidden it isn't on any map. Tens of thousands of people work there around the clock, most with no... Debrief: Explain what the Manhattan Project was and Tennessee's role in it. Then lay out the strongest argument FOR and AGAINST dropping the atomic bombs, and take your own position with evidence.	
9	Analyze the Yalta Conference and the tensions leading to the Cold War, and the founding of the United Nations as America's renewed commitment to... Notice: The war is finally ending, and three men sit for a photograph that will shape the next fifty years. They're supposed to be allies, planning the... Debrief: Explain what was decided at Yalta and how it helped lead to the Cold War. Then explain why the United Nations was founded and how it differed from the U.S. response after World War I. What is Tennessee's connection?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 6 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **SA troops march past Adolf Hitler at the 1935 Nazi Party rally in Nuremberg — mass spectacle designed to display totalitarian power.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is a 1935 Nazi rally at Nuremberg — tens of thousands marching in perfect formation past Hitler. Ask: the Nazis staged these events on...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1933	Fascism seizes power in Germany		
1941	Pearl Harbor brings the U.S. into the war		
1942	Executive Order 9066 interns Japanese Americans		
1944	D-Day opens the road to victory in Europe		
1945	The Double V and the seeds of civil rights		
1945	The atomic bomb ends the war		
1945	The United Nations is founded		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

World War II is the sharpest test yet of the 'more perfect union' question, because the contradiction is right on the surface: the United States...

Closing question: World War II showed the United States at its best and its worst at the very same time. Choose one example of the country fighting for freedom and one of it denying freedom, and argue what the war, on balance, did to the nation's founding promise. Then take a position on the hardest question in the unit: was the United States right to drop the atomic bombs? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

A War of Nerves

The Cold War • 1945–1991 | Standards US.59, US.60, US.61, US.62, US.63, US.64, US.65, US.66, US.67, US.68, US.69, US.70

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

For nearly half a century, the two most powerful nations on earth pointed enough weapons at each other to end the world — and never quite fired. The Cold War was fought with spies, propaganda, proxy wars, and fear instead of direct battle. How do you 'win' a war nobody dares to fight? And what does a democracy risk losing — at home — when it spends fifty years afraid?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

Cold War	_____	containment	_____
	_____		_____
McCarthyism	_____	brinkmanship	_____
	_____		_____
MAD (Mutually Assured Destruction)	_____	proxy war	_____
	_____		_____
détente	_____	Iron Curtain	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the origins of the Cold War and the U.S. strategy of containment (Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, Berlin Airlift, NATO). Notice: Yesterday's ally is today's enemy. The moment the shooting stopped in 1945, the two nations that had just beaten Hitler together turned to face... Debrief: Explain how the Cold War began and what 'containment' meant. Give two examples of early containment policies and how each worked.	
2	Analyze the Second Red Scare and McCarthyism — HUAC, the blacklist, and the Rosenberg case — as a civil-liberties crisis born of Cold War fear. Notice: Someone points at you and says you're the enemy. They have no proof — just a claim — but the claim alone is enough to get you fired, blacklisted... Debrief: Explain what McCarthyism was and how it harmed Americans, using HUAC and the blacklist. Then explain the tension the Rosenberg case reveals: how can it be true both that Soviet spies existed AND that the Red Scare went too far?	
3	Analyze the causes, course, and outcome of the Korean War — containment's first shooting test. Notice: A line on a map, drawn in a hurry, splits a country in two — communist on one side, not on the other. Then one morning the tanks roll across it... Debrief: Explain how the Korean War tested the U.S. strategy of containment, and describe its outcome. Why was Truman's decision to fire MacArthur significant?	
4	Analyze Eisenhower's strategy of brinkmanship and the nuclear arms race that filled American life with the fear of sudden annihilation. Notice: Your teacher stops class, and everyone crawls under their desks and covers their heads — practicing for the end of the world. That was a normal... Debrief: Explain Eisenhower's strategy of brinkmanship and the idea of Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD). Then describe two ways nuclear fear shaped everyday American life. What was Eisenhower warning about with the 'military-industrial complex'?	
5	Analyze the Space Race as an arena of Cold War competition, from the shock of Sputnik to the Moon landing. Notice: One night in 1957, Americans went outside and looked up — and saw a Soviet machine crossing the sky. A little metal ball called Sputnik, beeping... Debrief: Explain why the launch of Sputnik alarmed Americans and how the U.S. responded. Then explain how the Space Race was really part of the Cold War, using the Moon landing as evidence.	
6	Analyze the Cuban Revolution, the Bay of Pigs, and the Cuban Missile Crisis — the closest the world came to nuclear war. Notice: Thirteen days. For thirteen days in October 1962, the entire human race was closer to nuclear annihilation than it has ever been before or since —... Debrief: Explain how the Cuban Missile Crisis began and how it was resolved. Why is it considered the most dangerous moment of the Cold War, and what did the two sides do afterward to reduce the risk of nuclear war?	
7	Analyze the causes and course of the Vietnam War and the roles of Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon in escalating and ending it. Notice: You're nineteen, drafted, and dropped into a jungle on the other side of the planet to fight an enemy you can't see, for a village that isn't sure... Debrief: Explain why the U.S. could not win in Vietnam despite its military superiority. Then summarize how Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon each handled the war. Why is Linh's perspective important to understanding it?	
8	Analyze the antiwar movement and the deep divisions the Vietnam War created on the American home front. Notice: For the first time in history, Americans could watch a war on television during dinner — the real thing, blood and all, every single night. And... Debrief: Explain why the Vietnam War so deeply divided the American home front. Give two causes of the antiwar movement, and then explain — fairly — why some	

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
	Americans saw the protests as betrayal. Can you honor both the soldier and the protester?	
9	Analyze détente and the eventual peaceful end of the Cold War, from Nixon's diplomacy to the fall of the Berlin Wall. Notice: After decades of pointing weapons at each other, the two superpowers did something almost stranger than war: they started talking. And then, one... Debrief: Explain what détente was and give two examples. Then explain how the Cold War finally ended. Why is it significant that it ended largely without direct war between the superpowers?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 7 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **American transport planes at Berlin's Tempelhof Airport during the 1948–49 Berlin Airlift, which supplied 2.5 million blockaded West Berliners entirely by air.**

- Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?

- Spark's question: *These are American planes at Berlin during the 1948–49 airlift, feeding a blockaded city entirely from the air. Ask: the U.S. beat the Berlin...*

- What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1948	The Berlin Airlift		
1950	The Korean War		
1954	The peak of McCarthyism		
1962	The Cuban Missile Crisis		
1969	Apollo 11 lands on the Moon		
1975	The fall of Saigon ends the Vietnam War		
1989	The Berlin Wall falls		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The Cold War is the 'more perfect union' question turned inward. For nearly fifty years, the United States told the world it stood for freedom...

Closing question: The Cold War asked Americans to defend freedom abroad while fear tempted them to shrink it at home. Choose one example where the U.S. lived up to its ideals in the Cold War and one where fear led it to betray them, and argue what the whole era did to the nation's founding promise. Then take a position: did the U.S. 'win' the Cold War, and at what cost? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

The Good Life — and Its Fine Print

Postwar America • 1945–1963 | Standards US.71, US.72, US.73, US.74, US.75, US.76, US.77

Name _____

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

After World War II, America built something new: a booming, comfortable, television-and-automobile good life that made it the envy of the world. But whose good life was it? Behind the shiny suburbs and the family sitcoms lay a country that offered the dream to some and quietly locked others out — and a generation of teenagers who would soon ask why. Was the 1950s a golden age, or a golden cage?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

consumer culture _____

suburb _____

Interstate Highway System _____

rock 'n' roll _____

G.I. Bill _____

baby boom _____

redlining _____

New Frontier _____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the postwar economic boom, consumer culture, and the G.I. Bill's role in building the suburban middle class — and who it left out. Notice: Imagine the government hands you a deal: free college, job training, and a loan to buy a house with almost no money down. Millions of returning... Debrief: Explain how the G.I. Bill and the postwar boom built a large middle class. Then explain how and why that prosperity was unequal. Was the 1950s 'American Dream' available to all Americans? Defend your answer.	
2	Analyze the baby boom and its enormous effects on the economy, schools, culture — and the women expected to make it happen. Notice: Seventy-six million babies. In less than twenty years, America had a population explosion so huge it would bend the whole country around it —... Debrief: Describe the baby boom and three ways it reshaped American society. Then explain the role women were expected to play, and why many felt a quiet discontent. How might that discontent matter later?	
3	Analyze Eisenhower's domestic achievements — the Interstate Highway System and the polio vaccine — and his moderate approach to government. Notice: A disease was paralyzing tens of thousands of American kids every year, and parents were terrified to let their children swim, or gather, or... Debrief: Describe two of Eisenhower's major domestic achievements and their benefits. Then explain one hidden cost of the interstate highways. How does this show the unit's theme of reading the 'fine print'?	
4	Analyze how the automobile transformed American society — suburbs, commuting, fast food, motels, and shopping centers. Notice: A car isn't just a way to get somewhere. Give a whole country cheap cars and new highways, and watch it rebuild itself around the driver: houses... Debrief: Explain three ways the automobile transformed American society in the 1950s beyond just transportation. Then identify one long-term cost of building the country around the car.	
5	Analyze the explosive rise of television and its impact on American culture, politics, and consumerism. Notice: In 1950, almost nobody had one. Ten years later, almost everybody did. No technology in American history had ever spread that fast or changed the... Debrief: Describe how quickly television spread in the 1950s and three ways it changed American life. Why did making 'image' powerful in politics matter for democracy?	
6	Analyze the emergence of youth culture and rock 'n' roll — including Tennessee's central role and the Black roots of the music. Notice: A new sound comes screaming out of the radio, and it terrifies every parent in America — too loud, too wild, too Black, they say, for their nice... Debrief: Explain how youth culture and rock 'n' roll emerged in the 1950s, and Tennessee's central role. Then explain the deeper issue Etta raises about the Black roots of the music. Why does 'who gets the credit' matter?	
7	Analyze Kennedy's New Frontier — education, civil rights, the Peace Corps, and the Space Race — and the optimism of the era. Notice: A young president stands up and tells a whole country to stop asking what it can get and start asking what it can give. He challenges the nation... Debrief: Describe the main goals of Kennedy's New Frontier and give two specific examples. Why is his call to the Space Race a good symbol of the era's optimism? How does the New Frontier set up the 1960s?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 8 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **Row upon row of nearly identical mass-produced houses in Levittown, Pennsylvania, c. 1959 — a symbol of affordable postwar suburbia and, to critics, of conformity.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is Levittown — thousands of identical mass-produced homes. Ask: Levittown's own rules barred Black families from buying there. When you look...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1944	The G.I. Bill builds a middle class		
1950	Redlining locks Black families out of the boom		
1955	The polio vaccine		
1956	The Interstate Highway System		
1954	Rock 'n' roll and a new youth culture		
1961	The New Frontier's burst of optimism		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The postwar boom is the 'more perfect union' question wearing a big friendly smile. On the surface, the 1950s look like America finally delivering...

Closing question: The 1950s delivered a real, broad prosperity — and quietly left people out of it. Choose one way the postwar boom moved the country closer to its founding promise and one way it fell short, and argue whether the era, on balance, was a golden age or a golden cage. Then predict: which of its hidden discontents do you think will erupt first in the 1960s? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

The Fire and the Dream

The Civil Rights Movement & the Era of Movements · 1954–1975 | Standards US.78, US.79, US.80, US.81, US.82

Name _____

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

For a century after slavery ended, America had written 'liberty and justice for all' on paper and then denied it, in law, to millions of its own people. This unit is about the generation that finally forced the country to keep its word — not by waiting, but by marching, sitting in, riding buses, and being willing to bleed for it. How does a people with almost no power move a whole nation? And once one group pries the door open, who walks through it next?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

segregation _____

nonviolent direct action _____

Civil Rights Act of 1964 _____

Black nationalism _____

Brown v. Board of Education _____

sit-in _____

Voting Rights Act of 1965 _____

the movements _____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze Brown v. Board of Education and the fierce, sometimes violent struggle to enforce school desegregation. Notice: Nine words on a courtroom wall: 'Equal Justice Under Law.' For sixty years, the Supreme Court had said segregation was just fine — 'separate but...' Debrief: Explain what Brown v. Board of Education decided and why it mattered. Then explain why the ruling was so hard to enforce, using Little Rock or the Clinton 12 as evidence.	
2	Compare the different strategies civil-rights advocates used — legal challenges, nonviolence, and self-determination. Notice: You and your friends all want the same thing — justice — but you can't agree on how to get it. One says work through the courts, patiently, case... Debrief: Compare the strategies of Thurgood Marshall, Martin Luther King Jr., and Malcolm X. What could each accomplish that the others could not? Why might a movement benefit from having more than one strategy?	
3	Analyze how the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the student sit-ins used disciplined nonviolent action to break segregation — with Nashville as a... Notice: A tired seamstress refuses to give up her seat, and a whole city stops riding the buses for a year. College students dress in their Sunday best... Debrief: Explain how the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the sit-ins each used nonviolent tactics to fight segregation. Why did refusing to fight back make these protests so effective? What made Nashville's campaign a model?	
4	Analyze how the Freedom Rides and the March on Washington used courage and mass action to force the nation to confront segregation. Notice: Get on a bus, ride it into the Deep South, and dare the mob to stop you. That's what the Freedom Riders did — Black and white activists riding... Debrief: Explain what the Freedom Rides were and how Nashville students kept them going. Then explain the significance of the March on Washington. How did facing violence actually help the movement win support?	
5	Analyze the great civil-rights laws — the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 — and the Selma campaign that forced them. Notice: Marches and speeches can change hearts, but only a law can change the rules. After a decade of boycotts, sit-ins, beatings, and dreams, the... Debrief: Explain how the Selma marches led to the Voting Rights Act of 1965. Then describe what the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 each did. Why were laws necessary, not just protests?	
6	Analyze the movement's later phase and its cost through the 1968 Memphis sanitation strike and the assassination of Martin Luther King Jr. Notice: Two words on a sign, held by exhausted men who cleaned a city's garbage for poverty wages: 'I Am a Man.' In 1968, Memphis sanitation workers went... Debrief: Explain what the Memphis sanitation strike was about and why 'I Am a Man' captured the movement's next goal. Then explain the significance of King's assassination there. What does Memphis 1968 show about the movement's cost and its unfinished work?	
7	Analyze the related equality movements the civil-rights movement inspired — the American Indian, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements. Notice: When one group forces a door open, others walk through it. The Black freedom movement didn't just win rights for Black Americans — it handed every... Debrief: Describe the American Indian, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements, giving one leader or event for each. Explain how they were inspired by the Black civil-rights movement — and why each was also its own distinct struggle.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 9 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **U.S. Army soldiers of the 101st Airborne escort one of the Little Rock Nine to Central High School in 1957, after the governor tried to block integration.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is the 101st Airborne escorting one of the Little Rock Nine into school in 1957 — U.S. soldiers protecting Black teenagers from other...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1954	Brown v. Board of Education		
1956	The Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeds		
1961	The Freedom Rides face the fire		
1964	The Civil Rights Act of 1964		
1965	The Voting Rights Act of 1965		
1968	The assassination of Martin Luther King Jr.		
1968	The movement inspires new movements		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This is the unit where the 'more perfect union' stops being a hope and becomes a demand. For nine units you've watched the gap between America's...

Closing question: The civil-rights movement forced America closer to its founding promise than any moment since Reconstruction — at a terrible cost, and with the work still unfinished. Choose one victory and one thing left undone, and argue how much closer the movement brought the country to 'liberty and justice for all.' Then explain how one later movement (women's, farmworkers', or Native) built on what it started. Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Toward a More Perfect Union

Modern America • 1964–Present | Standards US.83, US.84, US.85, US.86, US.87, US.88, US.89, US.90, US.91, US.92, US.93, US.94, US.95

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

This is the last stop, and it runs right up to your own front door. In sixty years America argued about almost everything — how big government should be, whether it could be trusted, what it owed the poor and the planet, how to keep itself safe, and who was allowed to lead. It broke a president, ended a Cold War, was attacked on its own soil, and elected a Black president in the same century a Tennessee balcony took the movement's greatest leader. After 130 years of watching the gap between America's promise and its practice, the last question is the one only you can answer: is the union still becoming more perfect — and what will you do with it?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

Great Society	_____	counterculture	_____
	_____		_____
Watergate	_____	stagflation	_____
	_____		_____
Reaganomics	_____	War on Terror	_____
	_____		_____
the tech revolution	_____	a more perfect union	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze Johnson's Great Society and the 1960s counterculture as two very different responses to the question of what America should become. Notice: Two revolutions at once. In Washington, a president tries to build a 'Great Society' — declaring war on poverty itself and creating health care... Debrief: Describe two major programs of the Great Society and their goals. Then explain what the 'generation gap' and counterculture were rejecting. How were these two 1960s movements different visions of America's future?	
2	Analyze Nixon's 'silent majority' strategy and China opening, and the Watergate scandal that proved no one is above the law. Notice: A president pulls off one of the boldest moves in the history of American diplomacy — flying to communist China to shake the hand of a man his... Debrief: Explain Nixon's 'silent majority' strategy and his opening to China. Then explain what Watergate was and why United States v. Nixon mattered. What does Watergate teach about limits on presidential power?	
3	Analyze the rise of the modern environmental movement and its landmark laws and conflicts. Notice: A river so polluted it literally caught fire. A book that revealed the pesticides in your food were killing the birds. A neighborhood built on a... Debrief: Explain what sparked the modern environmental movement and describe two laws or agencies it created. Then explain the conflict the snail-darter case revealed. Why might environmental protection sometimes clash with other goals?	
4	Analyze Carter's presidency — stagflation and the energy crisis, the Camp David triumph, and the Iran Hostage Crisis. Notice: Imagine prices going up AND jobs disappearing at the same time — the two things that aren't supposed to happen together, both happening at once.... Debrief: Explain what 'stagflation' and the energy crisis were and how they affected Americans. Then contrast Carter's greatest success (Camp David) with his greatest failure (Iran). Was Carter's reputation as a 'failed' president fair? Defend your answer.	
5	Analyze the Reagan Revolution — its economic policy, its social costs and conflicts, and its Cold War pressure on the Soviet Union. Notice: After a decade of gas lines, hostages, and self-doubt, a former movie actor stood up and told Americans it was 'Morning in America' again — that... Debrief: Explain 'Reaganomics' and one result of it. Describe Reagan's approach to the Cold War. Then identify one social cost or conflict of the Reagan era. Why is it important to weigh both sides of this presidency?	
6	Analyze how George H.W. Bush managed the peaceful end of the Cold War and led a coalition in the Gulf War. Notice: The wall came down. The enemy America had feared for 45 years — the one with thousands of nuclear missiles aimed at your grandparents — simply... Debrief: Explain how the Cold War ended under Bush and why his restraint mattered. Then describe the Gulf War and Bush's coalition-building approach. Why was leaving Saddam Hussein in power a debated decision?	
7	Analyze the Clinton-era economy and the communication-technology revolution that reshaped how Americans live. Notice: Somewhere in the 1990s, the whole world moved into your pocket. In a single generation, America went from landlines, letters, and encyclopedias on... Debrief: Describe how communication technology changed from the 1970s to today, with two examples, including one benefit and one challenge. Then explain the Clinton-era economy and the debate over NAFTA. How did technology and the economy connect?	
8	Analyze the September 11, 2001 attacks and the War on Terror they set in motion. Notice: On an ordinary bright Tuesday morning, the country you've been studying for ten units was attacked at home — not by an army, but by nineteen men... Debrief: Explain what happened on September 11, 2001, and how the United States responded. Then explain the debate the USA PATRIOT Act raised. How does that	

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
	debate connect to earlier moments in this course?	
9	Analyze the breaking of barriers for women and minorities in government, culminating in the election of the first African American president — and... Notice: Go back to Unit 1. In 1877, a Black Southerner couldn't safely vote, a woman couldn't vote at all, and the idea of either one leading the country... Debrief: Give three examples of women or minorities breaking barriers in government. Then explain why Obama's 2008 election was historic, and its context. Finally: looking across the whole course from 1877 to 2009, has the country moved closer to 'a more perfect union'? Defend your answer with evidence from at least two units.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 10 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **President Johnson signs Medicare and Medicaid into law in 1965 (with former President Truman beside him) — a cornerstone of the Great Society.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?

2. Spark's question: *This is President Johnson signing Medicare in 1965, with former President Truman — who had tried and failed to pass health insurance — beside him...*

3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1965	The Great Society builds a safety net		
1974	Watergate: the system holds		
1970	The environmental movement wins protection		
1991	The Cold War ends peacefully		
2001	The September 11 attacks		
2009	The first African American president		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This is where the whole course comes home. For ten units and 130 years, you've measured America against its own founding promise — 'a more perfect...

Closing question: You've now traveled the entire arc, from 1877 to today. Looking back across all ten units, argue whether the United States has, on balance, moved closer to its founding promise of 'a more perfect union' — using at least three moments from different units as evidence. Then, because this is your country now: name one part of the promise you think is still unfinished, and one thing your generation could do about it. There's no answer key. This one is yours to write.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:
